



Performance Treanor

TRAIN THE MIND, BODY AND SOUL

How to Lose Fat - A Definitive Guide

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Introduction

So, I'm writing this short manual to help my clients understand how fat loss works. Having been a fitness geek for the last decade or so I often forget that the average person may not understand the science behind weight loss in the same way that I do. It is pretty simple, really, but it's often overcomplicated by magazines, books and online articles which leads to people getting confused and jumping from one diet or training program to another and never really making any progress.

At its core, weight loss comes down to Calories in vs Calories Out. If a person consumes less calories than he/she requires to maintain their current weight, then they will lose weight. If a person consumes more than they require, then they will gain weight. This is known as The Law of Thermodynamics. Every successful weight loss journey must be based around this law.

This law explains why certain people can't seem to lose weight even when they exercise and eat healthy every day. Take, for instance a woman who weighs 50kg (110 pounds). She would require around 1700 calories a day to maintain her current weight. So, let's have a look at her diet log on the next page. (Fig 1)

Now, as you can see, this woman is eating quite "clean". There's no obvious junk foods in her diet. However, she is simply consuming too many calories. Even if this woman went for a jog and burned off an extra 300 calories every day, she would STILL be in a caloric surplus and would actually be gaining weight. In this case, her "Calories In" would be 2200 and her "Calories Out" would be 1900.

On the other hand, we could have a man who weighs 110kg (242 pounds), eats 3000 calories a day including a lot of junk food, does no exercise and yet is still losing weight. This is because, as a bigger person, this man needs more calories in order to maintain his current weight. In this case, this big man would require about 3500 calories just to maintain his current weight. (Fig 2)

So, yes, unfortunately some people have it harder than others. If you're a small, light, inactive person who sits at a desk all day and doesn't exercise, you will have to be much more careful with your diet than someone who is much larger and/or more physically active.

Breakfast		Calories	Carbs	Fat	Protein	Fiber	Sugar	
Tesco. - Sultanas, 20 g		62	15	0	1	0	13	⊖
Honey, 2 tsp(s)		43	12	0	0	0	12	⊖
Eggs - Hard-boiled (whole egg), 3 large		233	2	16	19	0	2	⊖
Milk - Whole, 240 mL		150	12	8	8	0	12	⊖
Odlums - Porridge Oats, 80 g		400	51	5	8	7	1	⊖
Add Food Quick Tools		888	92	29	36	7	40	
Lunch		Calories	Carbs	Fat	Protein	Fiber	Sugar	
Yoplai - Yoghurt, 125 gr		53	8	0	5	0	0	⊖
Turbana - Banana, 1 medium banana		100	20	0	1	3	16	⊖
Add Food Quick Tools		153	28	0	6	3	16	
Dinner		Calories	Carbs	Fat	Protein	Fiber	Sugar	
Aladdin - Grilled Salmon Fillets, 2 Fillet		482	0	27	56	0	0	⊖
Raw Assorted Vegetables - Mixed Vegetables*, 2 cup		40	8	0	2	4	0	⊖
Add Food Quick Tools		522	8	27	58	4	0	
Snacks		Calories	Carbs	Fat	Protein	Fiber	Sugar	
Lindt - Lindt 90% Dark Chocolate, 4 squares		240	12	22	4	5	3	⊖
Tesco - Mixed Nuts & Raisins, 3 oz hand full		390	19	28	11	7	18	⊖
Add Food Quick Tools		630	31	50	15	12	21	
Totals		2,193	159	106	115	26	77	
Your Daily Goal		1,600	120	62	140	25	49	
Remaining		-593	-39	-44	25	-1	-28	
		Calories	Carbs	Fat	Protein	Fiber	Sugar	

Figure 1 – This is an example of a woman who is accidentally consuming too many calories. As you can see, her goal was 1600 but she ended up eating nearly 2200. This is why it's important to track calories and see where you're going wrong;

Introduction

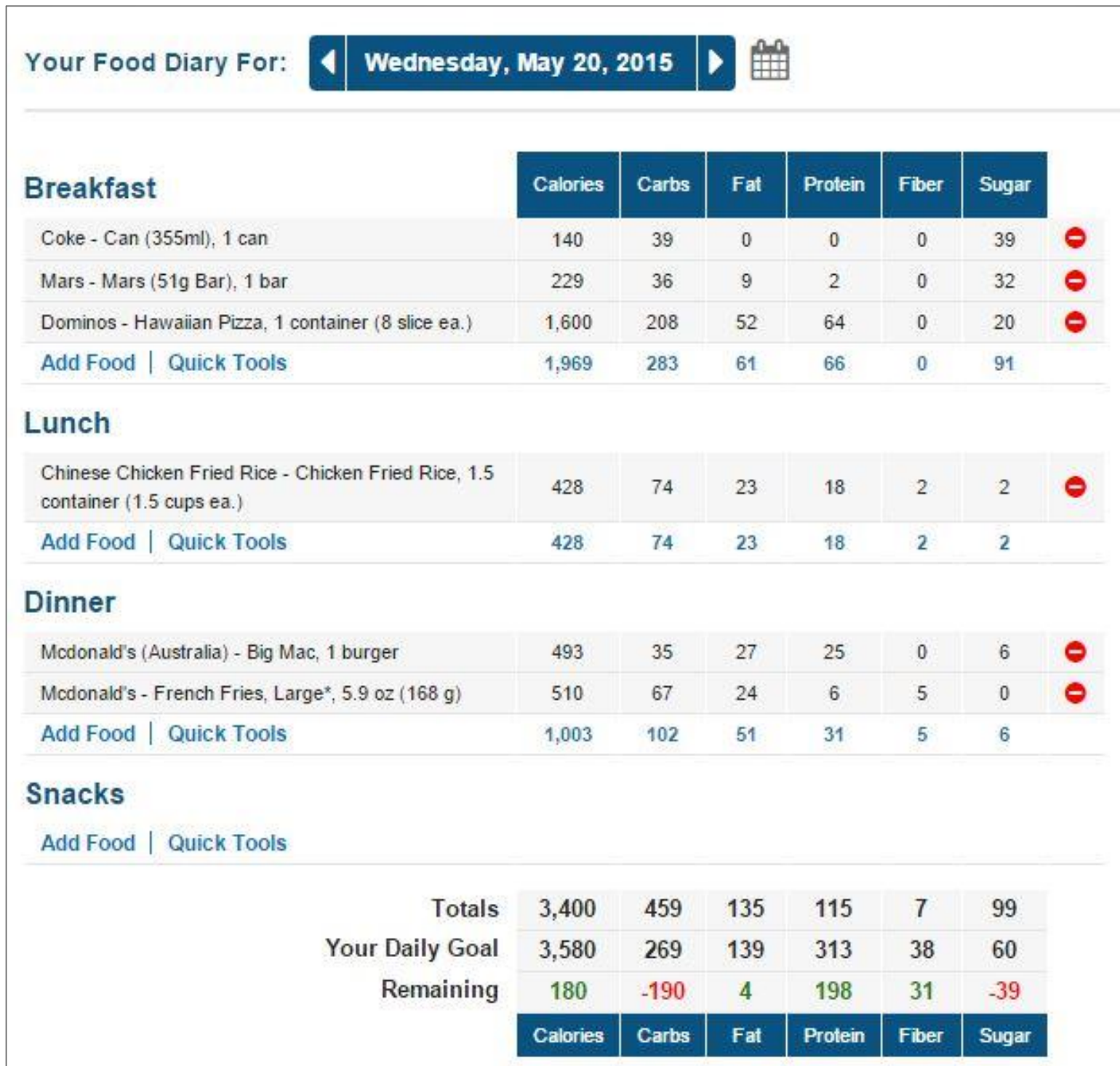


Figure 2- This is an example of a large man's diet. As you can see, his diet is based around junk food. However, he is still consuming underneath his Maintenance level and so will be losing weight, slowly.

Introduction

Now, this latter example is quite extreme and will probably not lead to long term weight loss in the real world. Why? Well there's several reasons.

- Lack of fibre in the diet
- Lack of protein in the diet
- Large amounts of sugar in the diet
- Lack of vitamins, minerals, nutrients.

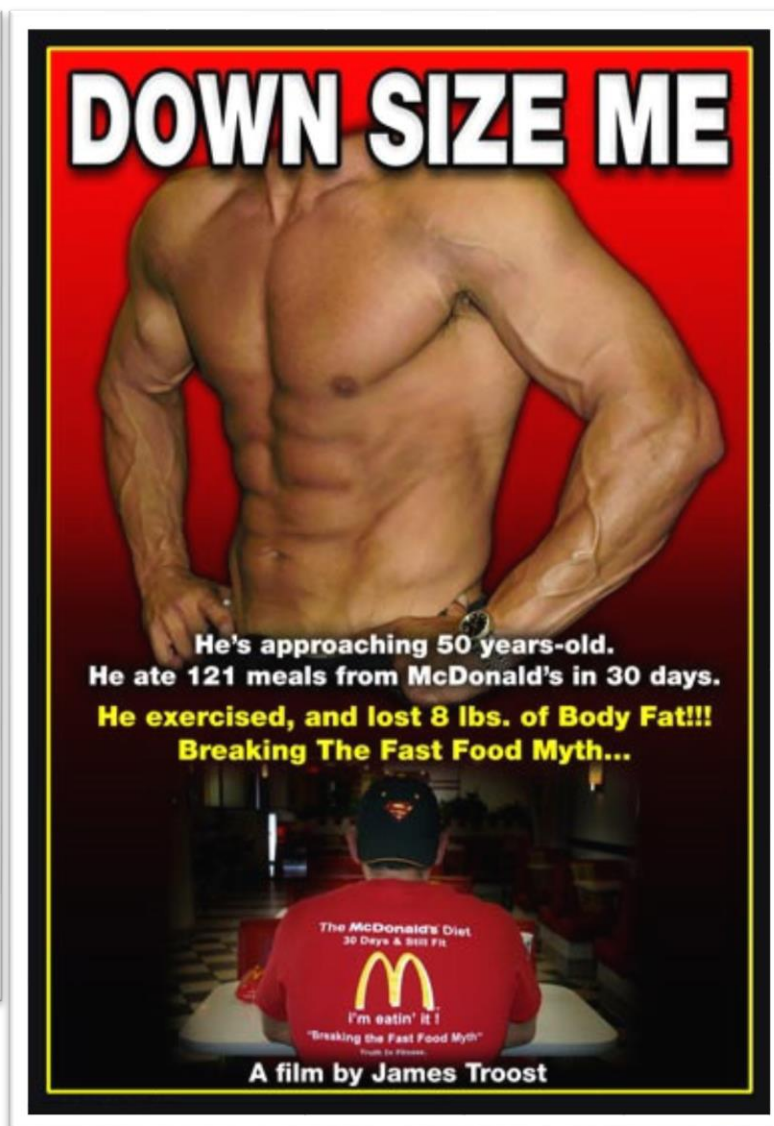
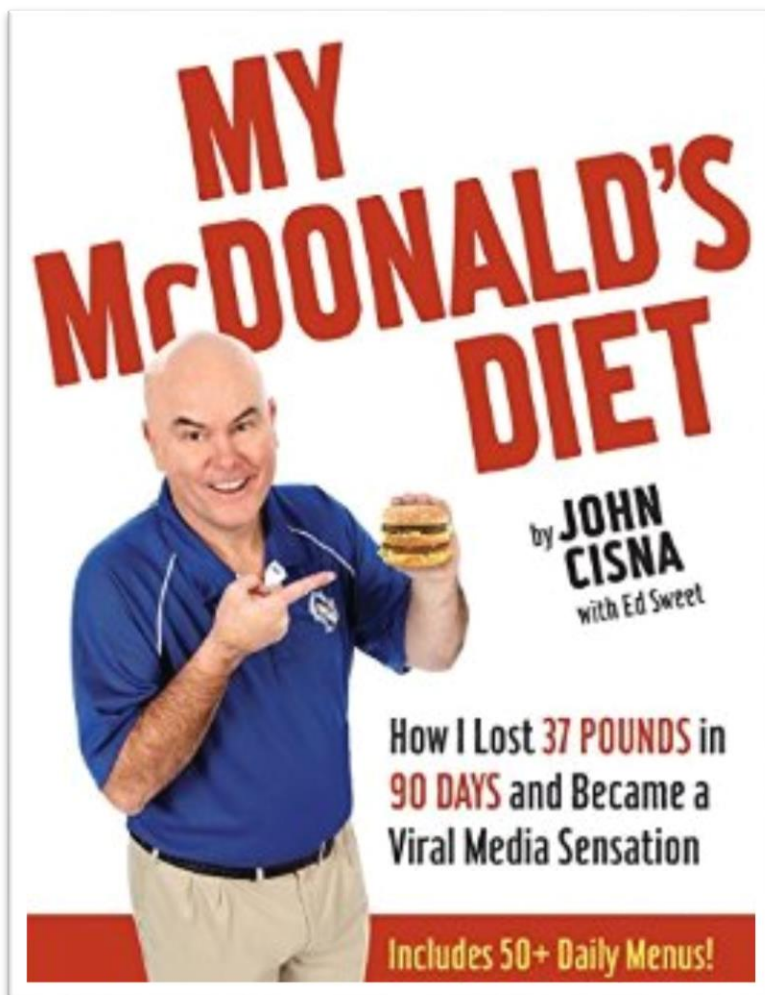
Fibre and protein are the two main things that keep us full. When there's a lack of these in the diet, people tend to be hungry constantly and end up getting cravings and eating everything around them. Also, low protein diets lead to muscle loss and poor performance and recovery.

The massive amounts of sugar in this man's diet will also cause hunger spikes, energy crashes, cravings, inflammation and joint pain and will make him much more susceptible to sickness and disease, (Eg. Diabetes) not to mention destroying his teeth and skin quality.

Because his diet consists of heavily processed products and very little "real" food, he will be getting no vitamins, minerals or nutrients which are vital to our health. Again, he will likely end up sick and with little energy. Even if he does lose weight in the short term, he will be likely to gain the weight back when he ends up sick and injured as a result of his nutritionally bereft diet.

Very few people manage to lose weight successfully whilst eating junk foods. However, it IS possible. There have been experiments performed where men ate only junk food for 1-3 months, counted their calories and ensured they were in a deficit and ended up losing weight.

They did this just to prove that the Law of Thermodynamics always applies. Again, these guys religiously tracked every calorie they ate/burned and used all of their willpower to resist hunger/ cravings just for the sake of the experiment. In the real world, we only know a rough estimate of our calories in and calories out, thus we will not be successful if we try to lose weight eating junk food.



Similar in premise to Super Size Me and just as fun but with a very different ending." - Houston Chronicle



Contact the Filmmakers on IMDbPro »

Fat Head (2009)

104 min | Documentary | 3 February 2009 (USA)



Your rating: ★★★★★★ 7.2/10

Ratings: 7.2/10 from 1,410 users

Reviews: 37 user | 2 critic

A comedian replies to the "Super Size Me" crowd by losing weight on a fast-food diet while demonstrating that almost everything you think you know about the obesity "epidemic" and healthy eating is wrong.

Director: Tom Naughton

Writer: Tom Naughton

Stars: Peter Paddon, Tom Naughton, Chareva Naughton |

See full cast and crew »

Figure 3- While these guys proved it IS possible to lose weight eating junk food, it is certainly not recommended. The Law of Thermodynamics always applies, but eating junk food will cause health problems and probably backfire on you in the long run.

So, I hope by now you understand the importance of calories and how they are the main factor when it comes to losing weight. They are certainly not the **ONLY** factor and eating 90% clean, healthy foods is certainly recommended. However, it is clear that we can afford to have about 10% of our calories from un-clean sources and still lose weight and remain healthy. Also, vitally, this helps us retain our sanity and allows us to have the occasional treat meal with our friends or family.

We just have to be calorie-conscious. For instance, I know that if I'm going to be attending a party where I'll be eating beers and BBQ, I will consciously make an effort to restrict my calories the day before and the day after the party. This way the excess calories I consumed will balance out.

I would do this by consuming mostly vegetables and lean meat prior to and after the party. These foods are full of protein and fibre yet contain very little calories (Chicken or tuna salad would be a good example). Doing this ensures I won't be hungry but will have created a big "gap" for the calories from the beer and BBQ.

This is known as "**Flexible Dieting**" and is the most reliable way to keep our diet on track. Expecting people to eat 100% clean all the time just isn't realistic. Someone might be able to eat perfectly for a few weeks but eventually they're going to crack and this comes with the risk of then going on an all-out binge and eating nothing but junk for several days, leading to rebound weight gain.

It's better to just accept a biscuit when a friend offers us one than to resist temptation for a long period and then end up eating the whole packet.

In the next chapter I'm going to explain how you can figure out roughly how many calories you need to maintain your weight. From there, we can figure out how many calories you should consume in order to lose weight.

Finding how many calories YOU require

1. To Maintain current weight

Figuring out how many calories you require to maintain your current weight is pretty simple. **You take your bodyweight in pounds and multiply it by 14-16.**

If you are a female or you live a very sedentary lifestyle, then use 14. If you are a male (or a large female) and you live a very physically active lifestyle, then use 16. So me, personally, I weigh 185 pounds and I exercise a lot. So I'll multiply 185 by 16 and that adds up to 2900 calories.

A 155 pound female would multiply her weight by 14, and so she would eat 2170 calories a day in order to maintain her weight. Now that we know our maintenance level, we can go about setting calories for fat loss.

Setting calories for Fat Loss

There's two ways to go about this. We can either create a deficit through diet alone, or we can create a deficit by burning off calories through exercise.

Firstly, we'll go with the diet approach. **So, we take our weight in pounds and multiply it by 12.** So for me, if I want to lose weight, I multiply 185 by 12 and I get 2220. So this puts me in a deficit of around 700 calories a day.
($2900 - 2200 = 700$)

For our female, she multiplies 155×12 and gets 1860. So this puts her in a 310 calorie deficit per day. ($2170 - 1860 = 310$)

(Hint- Females and smaller people have to accept a slightly slower rate of weight loss than larger people. Sorry, that's just how it is!)

Alternatively, you can just eat at your maintenance level and burn off 300-700 calories through exercise. In my opinion, it's best to do a bit of both. Some days you can just do your diet and other days you can eat a bit more and do your exercise.

Or, you can do a little bit of diet and a little bit of exercise every single day. It's up to you. Exercise provides many health benefits and tends to be more enjoyable than just strictly dieting so I'd prefer you include the exercise. Exercise also slightly increases your metabolism but it's not a major effect. The one form of exercise that I believe is essential is strength training. I will expand on the reasons for this in a later chapter.

What NOT to do – extreme dieting

A quick warning. Do NOT go any lower than 25% below your maintenance level of calories for a sustained period of time. Doing this will mess with your bodies hormones, slow down your metabolism and massively raise your stress levels. It will also destroy your performance in the gym and lead to muscle loss. Your appetite will go crazy and in the long run you will likely end up experiencing rebound weight gain. Trust me, I've been there and done that.

So, in my case I would make sure not to go lower than around 2175 calories a day for more than a few days, or I can expect to experience these awful symptoms. For the female, she wouldn't go below 1600 for a long period of time. You would probably feel fine for a little while but eventually you will feel terrible and your metabolism will slow down so much that further fat loss becomes impossible until you raise your calories up and take a break from the diet.

Hint. The fatter somebody is, the more "emergency" bodyfat stores they have. In this case, they could probably do a low calorie diet for quite a while before they experience these symptoms.

For guys, these dieting symptoms will be most noticeable when you are below 12- 15% bodyfat. For girls, it would be below 22%. Once you reach this level of leanness, losing fat needs to be done slowly and carefully. (Otherwise, your body literally thinks it's starving to death and your hormones start to go haywire)

So, now that you know roughly how many calories you should be eating, I need to tell you what those calories should consist of. The three Food Groups are Protein, Carbohydrates and Fats. Again, there's a pretty simple formula to figure things out here.

Protein, Carbs and Fats- How much of each?

Just to make it clear, protein, carbs and fat are what makes up the calories we consume. Here's how many calories are contained in a gram of each.

Compare energy sources	
Energy Source	Calories per gram
Fats	9
Proteins	4
Carbohydrates	4

For anyone who's interested in sports, exercise and looking and feeling great, use the following formula to figure out your needs. Using the 155 pound female who wants to lose fat as an example, this is how we figure it out.

Her total calorie intake is going to be 1860.

For fat loss, protein is the most important, so we'll calculate that first. To do this, take your bodyweight in KG and multiply it by 2. So our woman in this example weighs 70kg. So, $70\text{kg} \times 2 = 140$.

So she's going to eat 140 grams of protein per day. Now, looking at our table above, we know that there's 4 calories in 1 gram of protein. So in 140grams, there is 560 calories.

So, we'll subtract that from her daily target of 1860.

$1860 - 560 = 1300$ calories left over, after setting protein.

Now, divide these calories up whichever way you prefer between carbs and fats. For the sake of simplicity, we'll split it completely evenly. So that makes 650 calories each from fat and carbs. Looking at the table above again, we know that fat is 9 calories per gram. So, 650 divided by $9 = 72$ grams of fat.

Carbs are 4 calories per gram so 650 divided by 4 = 162 grams of carbs. Now we have our three daily targets.

Nutritional Goals	Goals
Net Calories Consumed* / Day	1,860 cal/day
Carbs / Day	163.0 g
Fat / Day	72.0 g
Protein / Day	140.0 g

Figure 4- This shows how much carbs, fat and protein a 155lb female should consume if she wants to lose weight at a healthy, efficient rate.

So, now that you've got your targets, I have to show you how to figure out exactly how many carbs, fat and protein are in the foods that YOU typically eat.

Protein You need to feed your body with protein: it's important as it builds, repairs and maintains muscle tissue, which is important to our body structure. • Lean beef • Chicken breast • Turkey breast • Sirloin steak with fat trimmed off • Salmon • Tuna • Fish • Shrimps, prawns and other seafood • Eggs • Beans • Nuts • Natural yogurt • Cottage cheese	Carbohydrates Carbohydrates are a very important food group and shouldn't be dismissed. However, for weight loss, I would like you to get your carbs from both vegetables and fruits and reduce the amount of carbs you get from your typical starchy sources. Fruits are packed with goodness, antioxidants, vitamins and minerals and are great for snacks. Vegetables • Broccoli • Cabbage • Celery • Cauliflower • Asparagus • Sprouts • Any mixed leaf salad • Leek • Green beans • Spinach • Tomatoes • Carrots Fruit • Blueberries • Watermelon • Blackberries • Strawberries • Apples • Cherries • Raspberries Starchy sources • Oatmeal • Brown rice • Whole grain pasta • Quinoa • Buckwheat • Bulgar • Banana • Sweet potatoes	Good fats Good fats are also needed in your diet to keep your hormones balanced and stop you from feeling hungry. • Olive oil • Coconut oil • Oily fish • Avocado • Nuts Also include nuts. These are good for your overall health, are a good source of fibre, good for your heart and brain and good for lowering high cholesterol. • Macadamia • Almonds • Walnuts • Brazils • Cashews (Stick to dry nuts not salted)
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Figure 5 examples of each type of food group. The next chapter describes how to weigh and measure your foods to get the exact amount of calories, protein, carbs and fat they contain.

How to track your calorie intake

In this section I will describe the most important exercise of all. It involves a food scale, a pen and paper, a computer/smartphone and an honest dose of discipline.

This is where most dieters fail. They might eat healthy foods, exercise regularly, do yoga, get plenty of sleep etc. but if they don't know how many calories they're consuming they are almost bound to fail.

Some people can successfully lose weight just by doing the above but most of us aren't so lucky. The majority of us seriously under-estimate how many calories we're consuming and over-estimate how many calories we're burning via exercise. This leads to us spinning our wheels and never successfully losing weight.

The solution is to spend a week or two weighing EVERYTHING we consume, then jotting down how many grams of each item we ate. Then, you submit that information into a website or phone app like My Fitness Pal which will tell you exactly how many calories, carbs, fat and protein you are consuming.

The beauty of a website/app like My Fitness Pal, is that it will remember your favourite foods so that the next time you want to log a day of eating, you just have to click and select it from your list of commonly eaten foods.

Most of us eat the same foods over and over again throughout our lives, so getting familiar with how many calories are in each of them will serve us well in the long run. As an example, I LOVE dark chocolate and like to eat it almost every day. Now, I know from measuring it on my food scale and submitting the information to My Fitness Pal, that 4 squares of dark chocolate weighs 40 grams and contains 240 calories.

I know weighing and measuring foods and adding up the calories is really boring and tedious but just doing it strictly for a week or so will be a MASSIVE

eye opener for you. I couldn't believe how many calories were in a tablespoon of olive oil or peanut butter or a handful of nuts the first time I measured them. Now I know that even though those foods are healthy, they have to be eaten in careful moderation.

I also learned how to eyeball certain things. For instance, I can tell that 100 grams of chicken is about the size of the palm of my hand. I also know that this contains 30 grams of protein and around 4g of fat and 0 carbs.

These days, I don't even need to think about it anymore. I weighed and tracked everything I ate for such a long time that I just know what can be eaten in large amounts and what has to be limited. This will ensure I never let my diet go out of control, even when I'm on holidays.



Figure 6- I know from my days of tracking calories that 100g of chicken is about the size/thickness of the palm of my hand. I know this contains about 30g protein, 4g fat and no carbs. I don't need to weigh anything anymore but it's a good idea if someone is stuck with their weight loss and needs to figure out where their excess calories are coming from.

If there's one thing you should take from this booklet it's this. Get yourself a food scale and get tracking. It could be the weight loss solution you've been looking for all these years.

Exercising for Fat Loss

I'm going to keep this chapter quite brief. Mainly because teaching people how to exercise for fat loss is my job and I can't just tell you everything here!

What I will say is that even the best training program in the world can't make up for a bad diet. You could burn off 600- 1000 calories in a vigorous workout but then eat a pizza and end up putting on weight.

However, if that workout included strength training, at least some of the weight gained from eating the pizza would be muscle. If you only did cardio however, this would not be the case.

The more muscle you have on your body, the more calories you can eat on a daily basis, since muscle requires calories just to maintain. So that's another bonus of strength training.

A good program should encompass all aspects of "fitness". It should address flexibility, strength, endurance and core stability. These should be assessed regularly.

The main focus should be on progressive overload. This means that every exercise you do needs to be progressed from workout to workout. For instance, a girl might do 10 press ups on her knees in week 1. In week 2 she should be able to do 12-15 press ups on her knees. In week 3 she can progress to full press ups on a raised bench/bar. Then in week 4 she could progress to full press ups on the ground, then she could start doing dumbbell bench presses and gradually increasing the weights each week. If you aren't using progressive overload, then you're just exercising, you're not actually "training".

Your strength training program should be balanced. For every "pushing" exercise you do, eg. bench press, press up, shoulder press) you should do

equally as many “pulling” (eg. Chin ups, seated rows, lat pulldown) exercises, if not more. This will keep your shoulders healthy and stop you developing poor posture.

You should choose “compound” exercises instead of isolation exercises. This means exercises that use more than one muscle group. Eg. Squats. Squats challenge the core, quads, glutes and hamstrings. Whereas a bicep curl challenges only the biceps. The compound exercises will burn far more calories and result in much more muscle growth and fat loss. In general, sets per exercise should be 2-5 and reps should be 5-15.

Here are certain targets that you should aim to achieve in your first 6 months of training

Men

Women

20 consecutive press ups	10 consecutive proper press ups
5 consecutive chin ups (full length)	2 chin ups
Squat 1.5x your bodyweight on a bar	Squat your bodyweight on a barbell
do 12+ inverted rows (feet on box)	Do 8 + inverted rows (feet on box)
Row 500m in under 2:20	Row 500m in under 2:30

Strength training is the most important factor in transforming your physique. Even if you only ever did weight lifting and ate healthy you could get into stunning shape. The same can't be said for cardio. Without lifting, you will be losing muscle as you lose weight. This will lead to a flat and soft looking figure with no muscle tone.

Weight lifting should be done 3-4 times a week. High Intensity Interval training or circuit style exercising can be added 2-3 times a week for 10-20 minutes each time. Slow and steady cardio should be limited to no more than 30 minutes, 1-2 times a week. Walking can be done as much as you want.

On your days off from the gym you can do some core stability work such as planks. Stretching should also be done on these days.

How to track your Fat Loss Progress

So now that you know how to train and how to set up your calorie intake, it's time to talk about how to track your results in the real world. This is another part where people get confused and frustrated. Somebody can be training really hard, eating super low calories and yet still not be losing weight on the scale. I will talk about the reasons for this later on in the chapter.

First, I will describe the basic methods of tracking your fat loss progress.

Firstly, you should have some sort of measurements taken. This can be your skinfolds taken by a trainer with a bodyfat caliper, or it could be a tape measurement around certain body parts (usually waist/ belly button).

The "Gold Standard" is to get your bodyfat taken by a DEXA scanner, but this costs a fair bit of money.

Don't trust the electric scales or hand held devices that claim to measure your bodyfat. These are inaccurate and will vary depending on your hydration status.

You can also take your weight on the scale but this can be unreliable depending on many factors.

Some important advice when it comes to tracking your progress.

- Do it first thing in the morning, after going to the bathroom but before eating.
- For super reliable results, take the measurement 3 days in a row, then use the average result.
- Don't track anything more often than once a fortnight, fat takes time to lose. Patience is key.

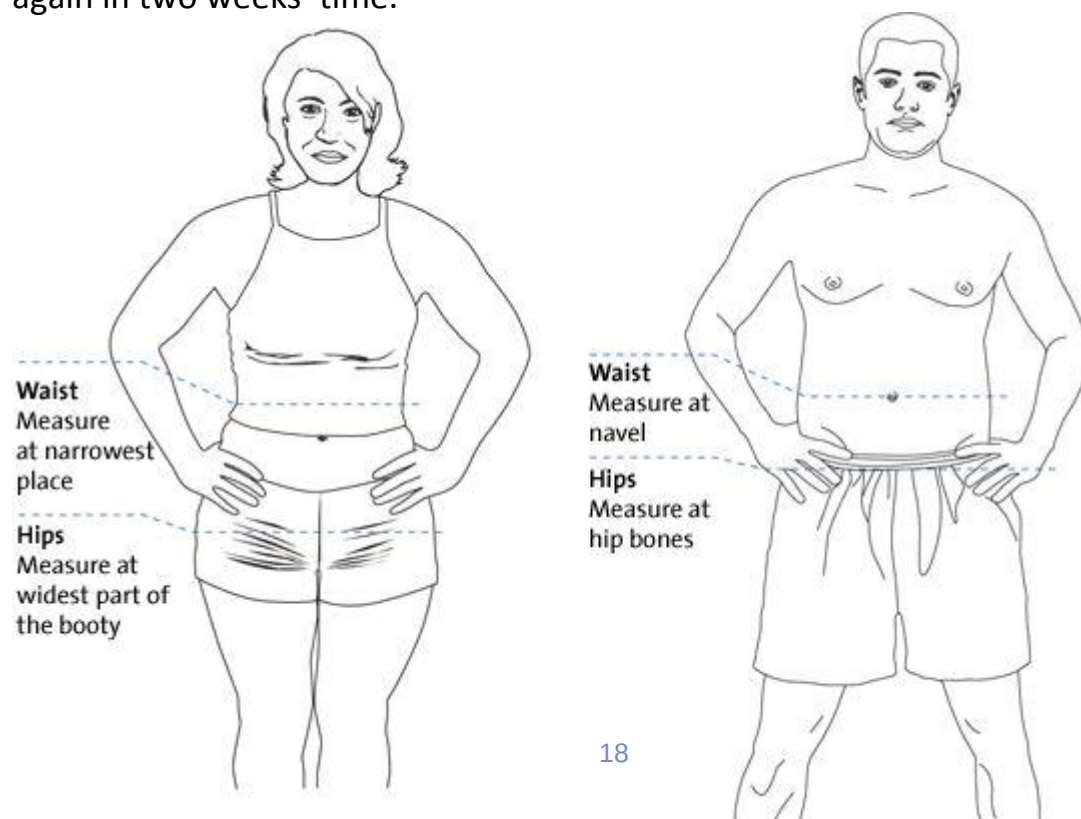
Now, the leaner you are, the slower you need to lose weight. If you are below 15% bodyfat for men, and below 23% bodyfat for females, you should not aim

to lose more than 1% of your total bodyweight per week. So, a 50kg woman should not lose more .5kg per week. Whereas a 100kg man could lose 1kg a week. Again, smaller people have to accept slower rates of fat loss. If somebody is super obese, they may be able to lose weight slightly faster than this with no ill effects, as their body will have plenty of emergency fat stores to draw energy from. This explains how the folks on “The Biggest Loser” can lose massive amounts of weight in short periods of time

For guys, a good goal to aim for is a waist measurement of 47% of your height or under. So, for me as an example, I’m 5’10, (178cm) so my goal waist measurement is 88cm or under (32.6 inches).

To take your measurement, you need to be completely relaxed. Exhale, then don’t breath in or out again. Don’t suck in or stick out your stomach. You should be in a neutral posture. Make sure you are careful to be very consistent with this. Men should measure around the belly button and women at the narrowest point of their torso, just above the belly button.

Not everyone loses fat from the same body parts at the same rate as others. Fat distribution is largely genetic and we can’t just choose which bodyparts the fat comes off from. That said, if you are dieting, your waist measurement should be coming down at least somewhat. If it isn’t, make some slight adjustments to your calorie intake/ exercise a little more and then measure again in two weeks’ time.



Waist Measurement Chart Women (in feet and inches)			
Height	Ideal	Overweight	Obese
5'-1"	24"	28.4"-31.5"	>31.5"
5'-2"	24.5"	29.1"-32.2"	>32.2"
5'-3"	25"	29.9"-33.0"	>33.0"
5'-4"	26"	30.7"-33.8"	>33.8"
5'-5"	26"	31.5"-34.6"	>34.6"
5'-6"	26.5"	32.3"-35.4"	>35.4"
5'-7"	27"	33.1"-36.2"	>36.2"
5'-10"	27.5"	35.5"-38.6"	>38.6"
6'-0"	28"	37.1"-40.2"	>40.2"

Waist Measurement Chart Men (in feet and inches)			
Height	Ideal	Overweight	Obese
5'-6"	29"	33"-36"	>36"
5'-7"	31"	34"-37"	>37"
5'-8"	31.2"	35"-38"	>38"
5'-9"	31.7"	36"-39"	>39"
5'-10"	32"	37"-40"	>40"
5'-11"	32.6"	38"-41"	>41"
6'-0"	33.1"	39"-42"	>42"
6'-2"	34"	41"-44"	>44"
6'-4"	35"	43"-46"	>46"

Now, science has shown that when somebody is consistently in a caloric deficit, that they will lose weight. If you believe that you are an exception to the rule, there's a couple of things to check.

- Are you SURE you're measuring you're calories in vs calories out accurately?
- Are you making sure you're not blowing all your progress at the weekend? It's very possible for this to happen. Somebody can achieve a 500 calorie deficit Monday to Friday. So that would be a 2500 deficit. Then they go out Saturday and Sunday night, drink 10 beers and eat a whole pizza and boom, suddenly they've consumed 3000 calories and an entire week's progress has been wiped out.

If you've done the above checks and are sure this isn't what's happening, there's a few more things that could be afoot. Are you losing weight faster than 1% a week?? Are your stress levels and sleeping patterns out of control? In these cases, cortisol is likely the culprit.

Basically, when your body senses that it's losing weight too fast, or is overly stressed or sleep deprived, several defensive hormonal responses occur. The stress hormone, called Cortisol starts to rise. When cortisol rises, several bad things happen. Your appetite starts going crazy, your mood will be disrupted, energy levels will go down, sleep patterns starts to get disrupted and so on. The effect that bothers most people though is that they seemingly can't lose weight.

The reason for this is, when cortisol is raised, the body holds onto water weight. The body can hold on to so much water that any fat loss this person achieves gets masked by the excessive water weight they're carrying. This is especially prominent with females. It's not uncommon to see someone's weight loss stalled for several weeks despite them eating way less than their maintenance calories.

In this case, people start to freak out and lower their calories even more and double the amount of exercise they do. This is the worst thing to do in this situation. This causes even more hormonal disruptions in the body and makes further weight loss impossible. It will also cause your metabolism to slow down drastically. You will also become more susceptible to injuries and sickness, particularly colds, flu and hay fever.

In this scenario, the only solution is to RELAX. Take a couple of days off exercise, raise your levels of carbohydrate in your diet and watch what happens. Cortisol levels will go back down and the water weight will start to be released. Once you begin to feel “normal” again, the diet can be commenced at a slower rate.

This is where the concept of a “cheat day” comes from. Basically, after several weeks of dieting and putting the body under stress, a cheat day tricks the body into thinking that the diet is over. Cortisol comes back down and your metabolism speeds back up again, making further weight loss easier. It’s like taking one step backwards to take two steps forward.

I will go into more detail about cheat days later because there is both a right way and a wrong way to do them.

To sum up this chapter, settle on a form of measurement and do it every fortnight, making sure to be consistent with the time of day (First thing in the morning). If your measurements are coming down and you’re feeling good and your performance in the gym is improving, then you’re in the sweet spot. ie. Losing fat and gaining muscle.

If your measurements aren’t coming down, perform the checks I mentioned above. If everything is in order, make some slight adjustments to your calorie intake or add a little bit more exercise and assess again in a fortnight.

Best/Worst Foods to Eat for Fat Loss

As I mentioned in the opening chapter, you can lose fat eating ANY type of foods. If you still don't believe me, have a read about "The Twinkie Diet". It is exactly what it says on the tin, a man who ate basically nothing but Twinkies for a 10 weeks and lost weight.

Twinkie diet helps nutrition professor lose 27 pounds

By Madison Park, CNN

November 8, 2010 8:40 a.m. EST



Mark Haub's Twinkie diet asks: What matters more in weight loss, the quality or the caloric content of the food?

(CNN) -- Twinkies. Nutty bars. Powdered donuts.

For 10 weeks, Mark Haub, a professor of human nutrition at Kansas State University, ate one of these sugary cakelets every three hours, instead of meals. To add variety in his steady stream of Hostess and Little Debbie snacks, Haub munched on Doritos chips, sugary cereals and Oreos, too.

STORY HIGHLIGHTS

- Nutrition professor's "convenience store diet" helped him shed 27 pounds.
- Haub limited himself to 1,800 calories and two-thirds come from junk food
- Haub said it's too early to draw any conclusions about diet

His premise: That in weight loss, pure calorie counting is what matters most -- not the nutritional value of the food.

The premise held up: On his "convenience store diet," he shed 27 pounds in two months.

For a class project, Haub limited himself to less than 1,800 calories a day. A man of Haub's pre-dieting size usually consumes about 2,600 calories daily. So he followed a basic principle of weight loss: He consumed significantly fewer calories than he burned.

THE



DIET

Figure 7 Probably not the healthiest diet in the world, but it did prove the point the professor was trying to make

Best/Worst Foods to Eat for Fat Loss

Now, in no way am I recommending that you follow a similar diet. (He likely lost quite a lot of muscle during this time, as well as the damage done to his insides) I'm just illustrating the point that weight loss ultimately does come down to calories in vs calories out. In the real world however, certain foods are going to be much more helpful than others in our weight loss journey.

500 calories from chicken, sweet potatoes and vegetables will provide us with far more energy, fullness and vitamins and minerals than 500 calories from Coke and crisps. There are several reasons for the former being so much more filling than the latter.

-Protein and fibre content is going to be much higher.

-The real food will take about 15 mins to chew and digest, whereas the crisps and coke will be devoured within seconds. The reason this is important is that it takes 15-20 minutes for our brain to "realise" we've eaten. It receives the signal and then lets us know that we are full and should stop eating.

For this reason, it's preferable to eat foods that are quite large, whilst still containing very few calories. Smoothies are fine in moderation but generally we should eat our food in its natural, solid form.

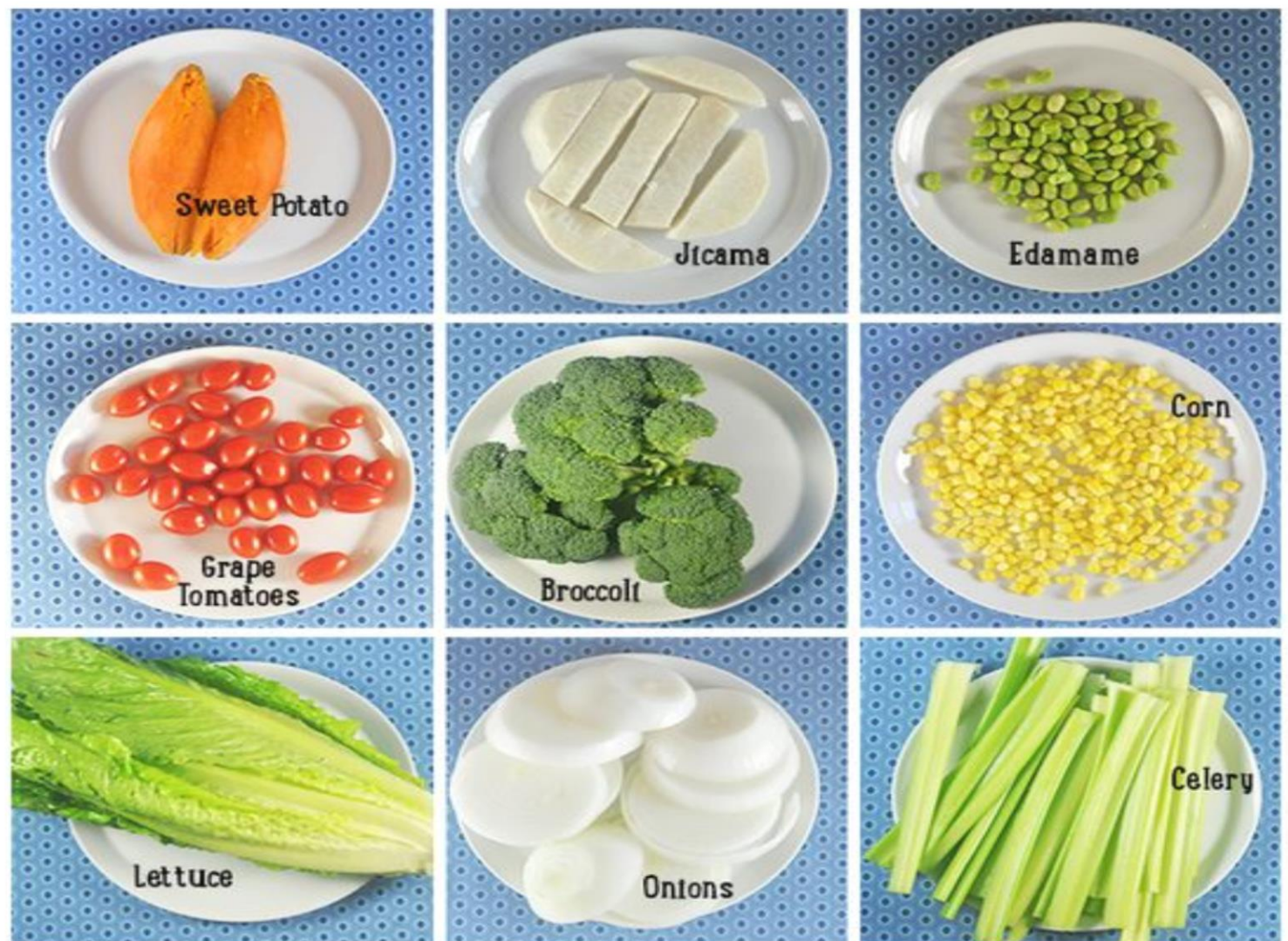
Some of the best foods to eat to fill ourselves up yet don't contain a large amount of calories are.

- Fresh or frozen berries (strawberries, raspberries, blueberries, blackberries)
- Apples
- Sweet potatoes and regular potatoes
- All lean meats (tuna, chicken, beef, turkey, kangaroo!)
- Any form of green leafy vegetable
- Protein powder mixed with yoghurt/oats

You'll find these foods in the fridges/ cupboards of any fitness fanatic. Now let's have a look at how 100 calories of certain types of food looks like.



Figure 8- Displays 100 calories each of broccoli, strawberries, bread, crisps and M&M's. Which do you think would be more filling?



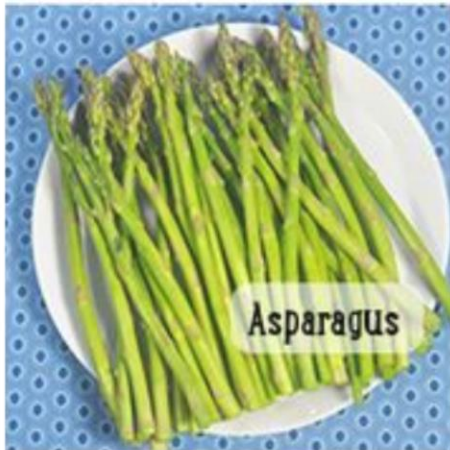
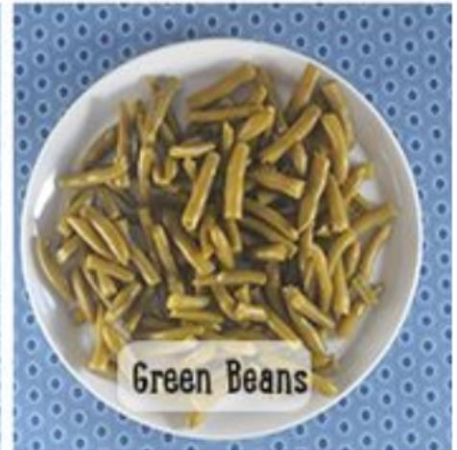
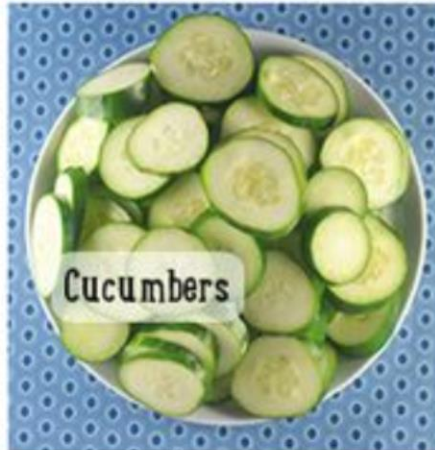
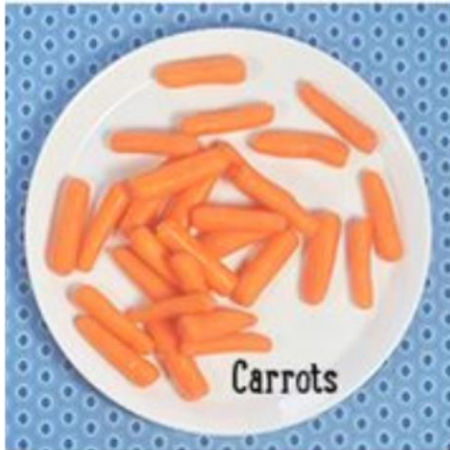
What Does 100 Calories of Veggies Look Like?

Best/Worst Foods to Eat for Fat Loss



Figure 9- Keep in mind these are the "fun-size" treats. About the length of your thumb. These will also contain lots of sugar, no fibre and no protein. Thus, you will find yourself hungry and craving more sugar again soon after eating them.

What Does 100 Calories of Veggies Look Like?



SPARKPEOPLE

Read article for detailed portion sizes and more.

Best/Worst Foods to Eat for Fat Loss

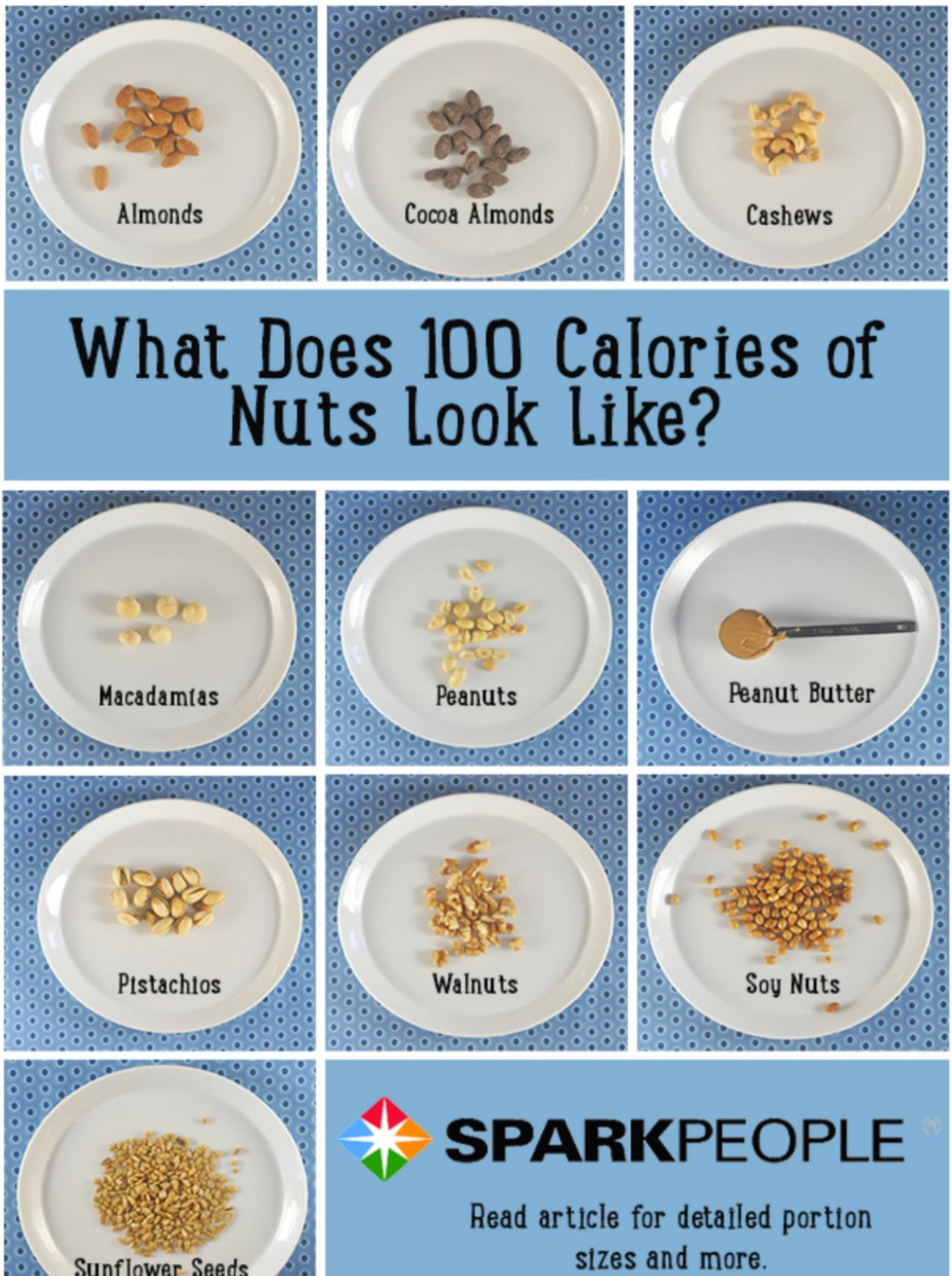


Figure 10- As you can see, you have to be careful when it comes to nuts. Even though they are full of healthy nutrients and contain no junk, they still have to be enjoyed in moderation if fat loss is the goal.

Best/Worst Foods to Eat for Fat Loss

I hope these pictures have given you some idea of the calorie content of some common foods. There are some more surprisingly calorific foods. Typically these are the high fat foods. Olive Oil, for instance, is a pretty healthy food, but it contains over 100 calories per tablespoon. Somebody who cooks all their food in olive oil could be unknowingly adding 100's of extra calories per day to their diet.

Sugary drinks like Coke are also some of the worst offenders. As are Latte's and cappuccinos that tend to be laced with full fat cream, full fat milk and plenty of sugar. Drinking these typed of drinks, you can easily consume hundreds of calories in mere seconds.

If you absolutely have to eat these foods, then you must balance them out by reducing your calories in other meals. Preferably though, go for Diet Coke or black coffees with only a dash of light milk or almond milk.

Alcohol

Alcohol is also particularly bad. There are around 200 calories in a pint, 160 in a schooner and this doesn't even account for the way alcohol tends to make our appetite go crazy and make us crave greasy foods.

As I mentioned before, it is easily possible to undo a good week of dieting by going out and getting drunk at the weekend. Getting drunk is generally always accompanied by fast food and then "recovery" hangover food the next day. When you add up the total calories consumed at the weekend by the typical young person, it's no surprise that so many of them are struggling to lose weight.

If you must drink alcohol, try and drink the ones that contains the best ratio of alcohol : calories.

Spirits mixed with Diet Sodas are your best bet. Light beers would be next. Cocktails are generally the worst. For more information, have a look at a website called "Get Drunk Not Fat.com". Seriously! It compares all the most well-known brands of alcohol and recommends which ones to drink in order to stay in shape.

As I mentioned, it's preferable to eat REAL food as opposed to processed foods or smoothies or protein bars. However, every now and again we get a craving

Best/Worst Foods to Eat for Fat Loss

for something sweet and convenient. In this case, it's important that we have some healthy treats on hand.

Fortunately, with a bit of protein powder and a bit of creativity, we can create healthy desserts that contain plenty of protein, fibre and good carbs/fats. These desserts will satisfy our cravings and also keep us full and provide plenty of nutrients. There are plenty of recipes available online. Just google any of these terms

Protein pancakes, protein cheesecake, protein oat bars, coconut protein balls... the list is endless. Just to prove it, I will list a couple of recipes here. Getting to eat these types of foods on a daily basis will go a long way to keeping your sweet tooth at bay.



Protein Packed Pancakes

Ingredients:
2 egg whites
1 scoop vanilla protein powder
2 tbs vanilla almond milk or skim
1 tsp cinnamon
1 tbs ground flaxseed
1/2 banana (mashed)
blueberries or strawberries

Mix together the egg whites, protein powder, milk, cinnamon and ground flaxseed. Mash the banana and add to the mixture. Add a handful of fresh or frozen blueberries (or any fruit you like!)

Spray a pan with olive oil cooking spray. Cook one side on medium heat until you see little bubbles. Flip! and cook on the other side until the middle is done.

Top with your favorite toppings. We suggest sliced strawberries and powdered stevia.



 BULUBOX.COM



Protein Balls provide a healthy alternative to sugary snacks.

Coconut Protein Balls

These amazing protein balls are quick and easy to make. They are low in calories, fat and sugar and are high in fibre and protein.

What you will need:

3 cups of dates

4 scoops of vanilla Isowhey protein powder

¼ cups of carob chips

1 ½ cups of almonds

2 tablespoons of cocoa powder

½ cup of warm water

1 cup of unsweetened coconut flakes

Method:

1. Combine the dates, almonds and water in a food processor and grind. This mixture doesn't need to be extremely fine, small chunks are ok.

2. Add mixture to a bowl and add the Isowhey protein powder, carob chips and cocoa powder and mix well.

3. Spread the coconut flakes on a flat surface and roll the mixture into balls over the coconut until completely covered. The mixture should make about 32 balls, depending on the size of your balls.

They will be ready to eat immediately. Store any leftovers in the fridge to snack on later.

Best/Worst Foods to Eat for Fat Loss



Ingredients:

- 1.5 cups gluten-free rolled oats, blended into a flour
- 1/2 cup unsweetened/unflavoured vegan protein powder (I use Sunwarrior Warrior Blend Natural)
- 1/2 cup rice crisp cereal
- 1/4-1/2 teaspoon fine grain sea salt, to taste
- 1/2 cup natural peanut butter, almond butter, or sunflower seed butter
- 1/2 cup pure maple syrup (or liquid sweetener of choice)
- 1 teaspoon pure vanilla extract
- 3 tablespoons mini dark chocolate chips (I use Enjoy Life)
- 1/2 tablespoon coconut oil

Directions:

1. Line an 8-inch square pan with a piece of parchment paper. Mix the oat flour, protein powder, rice crisp, and salt together in a large bowl.
2. Add in the nut/seed butter, maple syrup, and vanilla. Stir well to combine. If the mixture is a bit dry, add a splash of non-dairy milk and mix again.
3. Press into pan and roll out with a pastry roller until smooth. Pop into the freezer.
4. Melt the chocolate chips and coconut oil together in a small pot over low heat. When half of the chips have melted, remove from heat and stir until smooth.
5. After freezing the bars for about 5-10 minutes, remove from freezer and slice into bars. Drizzle with melted chocolate and freeze again until set. Store in the freezer for a week or longer in an air-tight freezer bag or container.

Best/Worst Foods to Eat for Fat Loss

Protein Cheesecake

Macro's: 834 calories; 123g Protein, 63g Carbs, 10g Fat

12oz - Fat Free Philadelphia Cream Cheese

10oz - Fat Free Greek Yogurt

2 whole eggs

3/4 Cup - Granulated Splenda

1/4 Cup - 1% Milk

1.25 Scoop - TruTwin Vanilla Protein (42.5g)

1 tsp - Vanilla Extract

1/4 tsp - Kosher salt

Directions: All ingredients at room temperature.

1. Preheat Oven to 325 - Prepare 6" cake pan with non-stick spray and parchment paper in the bottom.
2. Cream Cheese in mixer - mix on medium until creamy - scrape sides of bowl down.
3. Add splenda - mix on medium until incorporated - scrape sides of bowl down.
4. Add eggs one at a time while on medium. Again...scrape.
5. Add the rest of the ingredients - mix on medium for 3 minutes.
6. Pour in pan - extra batter in mouth - yum.
7. Bake at 325 for 30 minutes. Turn oven to 200 for 50min - 1 hour. Remove and let cool on the counter. Wrap and refrigerate overnight.



Figure 11 Make a protein Cheesecake and top it with whatever you want. Here's one with Cacao Nibs and another with Raspberry Sauce. The healthy way to Cheat!

Best/Worst Foods to Eat for Fat Loss

Hopefully those pictures show you that eating healthy doesn't have to be boring. Now, if you don't like cooking, there is one brand of protein bar that I would recommend. Those are Quest Bars. These bars are made of all natural ingredients, are high in protein and fibre, contain a small amount of healthy fats and basically no carbs. They are also delicious and far healthier than the protein bars available in most supermarkets.

If you struggle with a sweet tooth I recommend purchasing a mixed box of 12 Quest bars. This will be \$3.50 a bar from most health/ supplement stores.



EXPECT LESS
THE PROTEIN BAR FAMOUS FOR WHAT IT DOES **NOT** HAVE

- **NO** Sugar Alcohols (Original Line)
- **NO** Sugar Used
- **NO** Artificial Sweeteners (All Natural Line)
- **NO** Glycerine
- **NO** Junk Ingredients
- **NO** Soy Protein
- **NO** Gluten Free
- Only **4-6g** Non-Fiber Carbs

20g PROTEIN

Another thing I would urge you to do is check the Ingredients list on anything you buy. Often in Supermarkets you will find products that LOOK like health foods, but really aren't. They might say Low Sugar/ Low Fat/ Gluten Free on the box. However, when you look at the ingredients list you will see that Sugar, High Fructose Corn Syrup, Vegetable Oil, Canola Oil or wheat are the main ingredients. Some of these might sound healthy but they really are not!



What to do when Eating out

In this chapter I will describe some strategies you can use to limit fat gain from those situations where you KNOW you will be eating/drinking a lot of junk. For example, a BBQ or music festival with friends, or a Christmas dinner with dessert or just a boozy night out.

Wake up that morning and instead of your usual breakfast, just have a coffee and a meal consisting of as much LEAN protein and as many vegetables as you want. Repeat this for your lunch and any snacks you feel like during the day, leading up to the social event. Chicken/tuna salad would be ideal. Any high fibre, high protein, low carb/fat foods will do the job.

This combination of protein and fibre will keep you very full yet contains very little calories. So, you won't be starving by the time you get to your dinner/BBQ/party and you'll be unlikely to go crazy and binge eat everything you see.

You should also consider doing a weight training session just beforehand. This way, much of the extra calories will be used for muscle repair/building.

You could also consider doing some Intermittent Fasting prior to and the day after the big feast. This is simply where you skip your first two meals of the day (breakfast and lunch). Instead, you can just drink coffee or green tea. The idea is not to consume ANY calories. Drink as much water as you can and try not to sit around thinking about food.

Let's examine how this works out in regards calories.

We have a regular sized woman whose maintenance calorie level is 2000. She has a big Christmas party coming up on Saturday evening at 8pm. On Saturday morning she skips breakfast and lunch. At around 4pm she has a small meal consisting of 100g chicken breast and a lot of leafy green veg.

What to do when Eating Out

This contains less than 200 calories. She then goes to the gym, does 45 mins of strength training and doesn't eat anything afterwards. This session may have burned 200 calories or so.

Then, she goes to her Christmas party and eats a big Christmas dinner and drinks several glasses of wine/ champagne or whatever and has several slices of cake.

She can relax and enjoy herself, knowing that she had saved up a lot of calories in anticipation of this party. She might end up consuming a total of 3000 calories when you add up everything.

So, that puts her 1000 calories over her daily maintenance level. Now, the next day, she could repeat the intermittent fasting trick again. OR she could just do some exercise, burning about 300 calories and eat nothing but lean meat and vegetables for the whole day again. It is unlikely she will be hungry, given how many calories were consumed the night before. So, she might only consume a total of 1000 calories on this day.

So, effectively she's cancelled out the surplus from Saturday night by going into an equal sized deficit on Sunday morning. Thus, she will not have gained any weight from partaking in Saturday's party.



Figure 12- You CAN have the occasional feast. You just have to enforce some damage limitation by limiting your calories prior to and after the feast.

What to do when Eating Out

Having the discipline and the awareness to do this will allow you to enjoy a healthy social life, despite your diet.

Dealing with the hangover

The only time this is a problem is when the hangover is so bad that it makes you want to eat crap. In this case, you really just have to suck it up and show some willpower. Don't give in to your cravings. Just know that they will pass as the alcohol leaves your system.

In fact, fasting is one of the fastest ways to get rid of a hangover. Since alcohol is perceived as a toxin in the body, our body prioritises getting rid of it. Any food we intake just slows down this whole process. If you're really struggling, try taking some form of electrolyte containing drink. This will help you rehydrate. Powerade Zero is a good option. Dioralyte or Pedialyte sachets can also be used. Try to remember to take one of these before you go to bed after a night of drinking too. The hangover will be much reduced.

Do Not treat yourself to a junk food binge the morning after. This is the worst possible time to do so! Your body will be so busy trying to oxidize the calories from the alcohol and food from the night before that any more incoming food will have to be stored as body fat.

How to deal with Fat Loss Plateaus

Usually, fat loss plateaus happen when somebody has successfully lost weight over several weeks or months. Then, suddenly, the weight stops coming off. Now the reasons for this and the solution are quite simple. Let's take our average sized man who weighs about 180lbs and has a maintenance calorie intake of 2700 calories (180×15 , remember our formula?).

Now, this man eats 2200 calories a day, for a 500 calorie daily deficit, for a planned 20 weeks. Now, in theory that means that that man would be losing 1lb a week.

So for the first few weeks it's going great. He's losing 1lb a week.

Now, after 10 weeks his weight loss starts to slow down. He can't understand why...

Well, because he is now only a 170lb man, his maintenance calories are not as high as they used to be. $170 \times 15 = 2550$.

Thus, he is no longer in a 500 calorie deficit. His deficit is now only 350 per day, which means his weight loss is now slower. If he wants to continue losing 1lb per week, he has to reduce the amount of calories he's eating by 150lb again.

So his new level of calories on his diet is now 2050.

In several weeks, as he loses weight, he will have to do more calculations and make adjustments again.

Metabolism slowing down

Another thing that happens as we diet for long periods of time OR when we do an extreme crash diet is that our hormones start resisting against the weight loss. In most cases, this starts to happen at 15% bodyfat and under for men, and around 22% bodyfat and under for females. Here's an idea of how certain levels of bodyfat generally look on each gender.



How to deal with Fat Loss Plateaus

So, why do our bodies start to resist against the weight loss beyond a certain bodyfat %? Well, it goes back to the caveman days. Evolutionary speaking, getting too skinny was a bad thing. Rapid weight loss generally meant that food was scarce and the person was the victim of a famine. So, our bodies developed ways to hold on to emergency bodyfat.

Now, thousands of year on, our bodies still think the same thing is happening when we diet. When we purposely restrict our food intake, our body's think that we are going to starve to death and so they will do everything to make us put weight back on. This includes ramping up our appetite, slowing down our metabolism, raising our stress levels and so on.

So, what we have to do is "trick" our body into thinking we are not starving anymore. There's two ways to do this. One way is to take a diet break. This is just where we raise our calories to maintenance levels for a week or two. This causes our hormones to normalise. Then, we can recommence our diet once our metabolism is back up and running at full speed again.

Refeed Day

Alternatively, we can do a 1 day refeed. Now, this is NOT a cheat day. The idea is to raise your calories to slightly above maintenance for this day, HOWEVER, you do this by drastically increasing your carbs for this day and drastically reducing your Fat intake. Protein should stay the same as always.

The reason for this is that only carbohydrates produce the "trick" effect where our hormones temporarily return to their normal working levels.

We keep fat low on this day because our body will be focused on burning the carbs, and any fat we consume will be temporarily stored as bodyfat.

So, our normal sized man who maintains on 2700 calories, might eat 2800 or 3000 calories on this day. His protein would be at 165g (660 calories), his carbs would be upped to around 500g (2000 calories) and his fat would be kept as low as possible, usually ending up around 20g or so (180 calories).

So that makes a total for the day of 2840 calories. For the sake of this day, you are allowed to have some "treat" foods as long as they are low in fat and quite

How to deal with Fat Loss Plateaus

low in sugar. This will allow you a psychological break from dieting too. A bowl of coco pops with skim milk would be a good idea.

Alternatively, you can just eat tonnes of clean carbs like potatoes, rice, butternut squash, quinoa and so on.

If you're really craving some white bread this is the day to treat yourself.

Be warned though, you might find yourself very bloated on this day.

If you've been feeling tired and run down from your diet, you'll probably wake up the next day feeling fresh and re-motivated. Use this extra energy to have a super charged gym session. How often you should use these refeed days will depend on your bodyfat level.

For guys, if you are over 20% bodyfat, you shouldn't need to do any refeeds. Under 20%, you can do a refeed day once every 20 days or so, under 15% you can do it once a fortnight. Under 12% and you can do one every week. If you're under 10% it's highly unlikely you're reading this book!

For females, refeeds tend to make your bodyweight spike up rapidly. Don't worry. This is only temporary water weight from all the extra carbs. It will disappear in a few days. Again, use refeeds according to how you feel and your current bodyfat levels. I would say if you are over 25% don't do them. If you are under 25% maybe once a fortnight. Under 20% maybe once every 10 days and so on.



Fat Burning Refeed Day: 600g of Carbs



Rob Lipsett

✓ Subscribed

13,856

Figure 13 If you want to see what a Refeed day looks like in practice, check out this Youtube clip of my fitness model friend.

Supplements- What works and what doesn't

The supplement industry is a pretty shady world. Every week there's new "miracle" supplements claiming to be able to add lean muscle and strip fat instantly. There's hundreds of exotic supplements with supposed "detoxing" capabilities. Fat burners and weight loss pills are extremely popular too.

Unfortunately, the vast majority of these have very little scientific backing. Fact is, there's no proper regulatory body examining the claims these companies make. This means a supplement company can claim "*SuperFatBurner 2000 increases fat loss by 300%!*" and there is nothing stopping them from advertising that on the bottle and selling it in the shops.

This leads to many naïve customers getting scammed out of their money. Thankfully, there have been some legitimate scientific studies done and there are a handful of supplements that we know to be useful. Here is a list of supplements which I believe in. These are not essential but they will give you that bit of extra help.

- **Caffeine.** This can be taken in the form of coffee/tea or in a pure caffeine pill. It can help speed up your metabolism, improve your exercise performance and reduce your appetite. However, limit it to 1-2 cups early in the morning so it doesn't interfere with your sleep. Green tea has similar effects but not quite as strong. Stay away from fat burners and diet pills. These can help in the short term but soon your body will become used to them and the dosage will need to be increased, eventually leading to adrenal burnout and sleeping problems.
- **Vitamin D-** This has many health benefits. However, if you are living in a Sunny country like Australia then it is unlikely you need to supplement with it. A few minutes of sunshine a few times a week should keep your levels topped up. Otherwise, take around 2000iu a day.
- **Protein Powder-** Protein powder is useful in so many ways. It helps us recover, build muscle, stay full and it can be very tasty. There is endless recipes involving protein powder. It can be thrown into your smoothies

Supplements- What works and what doesn't

- and into your cereal etc. It also makes hitting your daily protein target so much easier. Eating meat and eggs constantly gets tedious after a while and we don't always have time to cook something up. In this case, protein powder comes to the rescue.

I would recommend ordering the Whey Isolate from a site called BulkNutrients. It's an Australian site and it's much better value than the shops. Their products are high quality, great value and not filled with junk like the supplements in Supermarkets. If you don't digest dairy well then order a plant based protein, either Prana or Sunwarrior brands. (Prana- coconut milk flavour is nicer). These are less tasty and more expensive than whey's however.

- **Omega 3 Fish Oil** – This is another supplement with a massive amount of benefits. It will ease joint pain, reduce risk of disease, reduce inflammation and is a great source of fatty acids which are vital to our health. Make sure you just get the Omega 3. We don't need extra omega 6 or 9 in our diets. Also, be sure to get this in oil form. The tablets are a rip off. I recommend the Nature's Own bottle from Chemist Warehouse. Drink a capful every day. (About 10ml or 2 teaspoons)

Multivitamin- This should not be necessary if we are eating a wide variety of good foods, like fruit and veg. However, just to be safe you could take a multivitamin tablet every day or just a few times a week. The best choices would be the Innate-Response brand or the Genuine Health Multi+ brand (These can be ordered from iHerb.com). Cheaper ones tend to provide the wrong combination of vitamins and in the wrong amounts. Again, this is not essential but if you are someone who finds themselves feeling sick regularly then this would be a good option.

Electrolytes- Electrolytes basically replace the minerals we lose through sweat. So, if you sweat a lot when exercising or playing sport you could benefit from an electrolyte supplement. Endura Low Carb is the ideal choice here. Just put a scoop or two into your water and drink away at it throughout your exercise/ sport. Powerade Zero/Coconut water could also be used, as could Hydralyte but they are not great value.

Supplements- What works and what doesn't

Creatine- If you want to be able to perform at your peak in the gym or in sports then creatine will give you that extra little boost. It will give you the energy to perform a few extra reps, lift a little more weight or sprint that bit further. Again, not strictly necessary but there is plenty of science backing its effectiveness. There has been some controversy about this supplement's safety in the past but there has never been any scientifically proven evidence linking creatine with any health problems. In fact, it's the world's most researched supplement.

Calcium- If you don't tolerate dairy well, then a calcium supplement would probably be a good idea. 500-1000mg a day will help your bones remain strong. Also been shown to slightly increase fat loss.

Zinc/Magnesium- Many people are deficient in these two, thanks to modern diets which are high in processed foods and low in "real" foods. Taking 15mg of zinc and about 500mg of magnesium at night will help keep your hormone levels balanced and also give you a much deeper and more relaxing sleep.

Digestive Enzymes- If you find yourself feeling bloated/gassy after eating, you might benefit from taking digestive enzymes. Lots of people are intolerant to dairy/gluten and will feel sluggish and heavy after consuming them. In this case, try taking some digestive enzymes with your meals. Apple Cider Vinegar can also help your digestive system. Mix a few tablespoons in with a glass of water or just pour some on your food.

Wheatgrass/Chlorella/ Lemon juice. I've often heard that these can help you "detox" but personally I've never noticed much. No harm though if you want.

Beyond these supplements I wouldn't really recommend anything else. If you really really struggle to sleep and cutting out caffeine hasn't helped, try taking a Melatonin supplement. It will help you get to sleep faster.

Aloe Vera juice, Green coffee bean extract, Acai, Raspberry Ketones won't do you any harm but they won't do much benefit either. Save your money and spend it on healthy food instead.

Checklist- What you need to do now

So I hope this manual has helped you understand a bit about how fat loss works. Achieving a calorie deficit either through diet or exercise is absolutely necessary. Any other diet/exercise regime that works, works by getting you into a calorie deficit, whether you realise it or not.

Low carb diets, Low Fat diets, Atkins, Weight Watchers, the 5/2 diet, 9 day Juice cleanses... All of them CAN work. However, there's no magic involved with any of them. All they're doing is getting you into a calorie deficit by restricting your eating in some way. Unfortunately however, most of these fad diets will leave you with some sort of nutrient deficiencies or just damage your relationship with food, because they're inflexible.

The best diet is going to be the one you stick to. In my opinion, this is going to be one where you eat 80-90% clean foods, and the rest of the time have a little bit of what you fancy, as long as it's roughly within your target amount of calories. After a few weeks of eating this way and measuring your results, you will be able to carry on without tracking the calories.

My main aim here was just to get you to understand the importance of calories in and calories out. See, many people will embark on a healthy lifestyle with the aim of losing fat, but they fail because they don't understand the Law of Thermodynamics. For instance, have a look at this poster (on the next page) which claims to tell you how to lose bodyfat.

The advice on the picture is all good, healthy advice but nowhere do they mention that you still have to achieve a negative calorie balance in order to lose weight. So, somebody could do all those things and exercise well, but then they might go and drink a smoothie with a full can of Coconut Milk, a banana, dates and honey, and then suddenly they've consumed nearly 1000 calories without realising it. They're not likely to lose weight doing that.

So, what I would urge you to do, is DO all of those things on the poster, get 7+ hours sleep a night but ALSO be aware that you can't just eat unlimited calories, no matter how healthy they may be.



If you do all these things, train well AND track your calories and your measurements regularly, (making slight adjustments when necessary) THEN you will reach your goals.

Just a note on what is a realistic amount of weight loss per week. If you achieve a 500 calorie deficit per day, for 7 days, that is a 3500 deficit. Doing this should mean you lose 1 pound of fat per week. We don't want to try and lose any faster than this. Losing any more than 1% of our total bodyweight per week is too fast. That's where you'll damage your metabolism and hormone levels.

Now, other factors will affect this in the real world. Muscle gain, hydration status, sodium intake, carb intake, menstrual cycle and stress levels will all affect your weight on the scale. For this reason, it's better to use your waist

Checklist- What you need to do now

measurement, skinfold caliper readings and your performance in the gym as a means of assessing progress.

So now that I've told you how to set up your calories, protein, carbs and fats, all you have to do is spend a few days measuring out your food, tracking them using MyFitnessPal and you should be able to make out a meal plan for yourself. I'll even let you borrow my food scale so you can check how much of each food you can eat. I'll leave you with an ideal shopping list to get you started.

At the end of the day, it's boring, but it's what works. If you follow all the instructions in this manual and stick at it for several weeks, you are guaranteed results.

The Grocery List for Successful Nutrition

(all sources preferably grass-fed, pastured and/or organic if possible, but not necessary)

Proteins:

Chicken or Turkey, boneless and skinless
Lean Ground Beef, Buffalo, Chicken or Turkey
Lean Red Meat (top round, sirloin, London broil)
Omega-3 or Pasture-raised Eggs
Scallops, **tuna**
Wild Alaskan Salmon
Yogurt, plain

Need	Bought

Vegetables & Fruits:

- Baby Carrots
- Baby Spinach, Triple Washed
- Bell Peppers (green, red, yellow, orange)
- Cruciferous Veggies (broccoli crowns, cauliflower, cabbage, kale)
- Cucumbers
- Mixed Frozen Vegetables
- Onions
- Apples
- Bananas
- Berries, Fresh or Frozen (cherries, raspberries, strawberries, wild blueberries, etc)
- Dried Fruit (apricots, dates, figs, prunes)
- Oranges

[illegible]

Grains & Starches:

- Beans (black, chick peas, kidney, lentils)
- Old-Fashioned Oats
- Quinoa
- Rice
- pumpkin/ butternut squash**
- Sweet Potatoes, Potatoes

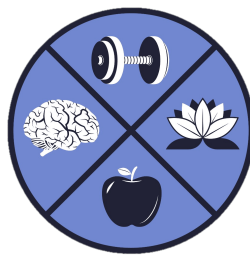
Healthy Fats:

- Dark Chocolate, 85%+ cacao
- Coconut, shredded, unsweetened
- Extra Virgin Olive Oil
- Guacamole
- Mixed Nuts (almonds, walnuts, pecans, cashews, pistachios, brazil, etc)
- Natural Peanut/Almond/Cashew Butter
- Pastured Butter
- Pesto
- Seeds (chia, hemp, milled flax, pumpkin, sunflower)

[illegible]

Miscellaneous Items:

- Coffee
- Hummus
- Salsa
- Spices (sea salt, pepper, cinnamon, nutmeg, onion powder, garlic powder, ginger, etc)
- Unsweetened Almond or Hemp Milk
- White/Green/Oolong/Black/Rooibos Tea



Thank you for reading

We hope this guide helps you on your journey.

Performance Treanor

Train the Mind, Body and Soul